well as deep recessions since about 2013, have seen Brazil and Russia slide recently. Yet the four original BRICs all remained within the top ten world economies in 2016.[36]

This section's focus on the distribution of material capabilities allows for analysis of multiple potential power dynamics involving the five BRICS countries, including the comparison between the BRICS club and that of the major incumbent powers, the G7, and the intra-BRICS distribution of material power capabilities.

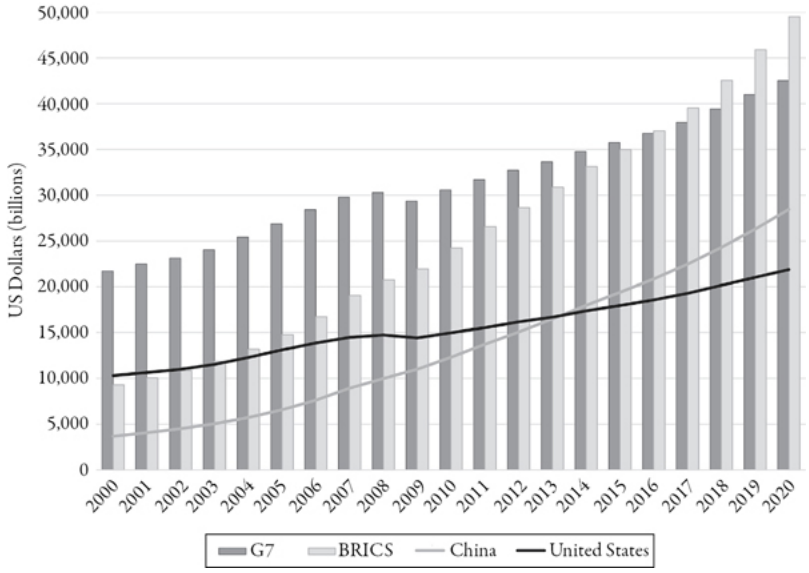


FIGURE 2.2 Combined GDP (PPP): BRICS, G7, China, and US, 2000–2020

Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2016; C. Roberts calculations.

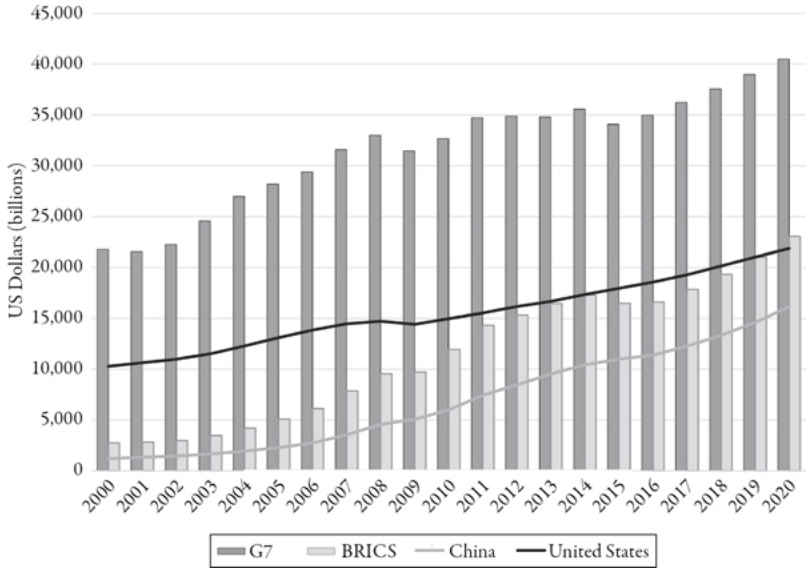


FIGURE 2.3 Combined GDP (MER): BRICS, G7, China, and US, 2000–2020

Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2016; C. Roberts calculations.

The Potential Power of Economic Clubs: BRICS versus G7

Over the last decade, China's economy grew to be almost double the size of the other four BRICS countries put together. Each of the three other original BRIC countries reached a GDP of approximately $2 trillion (in MER), similar to that of Italy, although Russia declined markedly since 2015. By 2020, India will likely power ahead of Italy and Brazil, thanks to markedly higher growth rates and favorable demographics. In this sense, China